HarvestNet at a glance

Surplus fresh produce reaches low-income households at food banks they choose, instead of going to waste. Donor and food bank agents negotiate the split, guided by a SNAP-style fair share. There's no central decider.

One line: **"Every organization keeps its own keys: nothing in HarvestNet can commit a donor or a food bank to a deal it didn't approve."**

Agents

- **Donor:** wants produce gone with little effort. Votes for itself.
- **Food bank:** wants produce its households will use. Votes for itself.
- **Advocate:** pushes toward the biggest fair-share gap. No vote.
- **Front-desk assistant:** takes requests. Never allocates.

Humans who approve

- Donor staff: promises and drop-offs.
- Food bank managers: large deliveries, "use soon" produce, truck runs.

SNAP, three ways

- **Fair share:** weekly pounds by household size. A published shared rule that assigns nothing.
- **Eligibility signal:** optional, self-reported, never changes the share.
- **Produce programs:** farmers markets as donors, plus Market Match tips.

Matching rules

- Agents read produce profiles, never crop names.
- Split each batch item by item, and agree who moves it (the donor drops off, or the food bank collects).
- Only to households that can collect before the produce spoils. Fridge-only produce goes to limited-fridge households same-day only.
- Every pound gets a recorded pathway. No silent waste.

When a deal is final

- Every named organization has approved the same version, and every hold is valid.
- Any change creates a new version, so approvals must be given again.
- Three rounds with no new terms: preserved disagreement.
- Deadline: unclaimed, with a reason. Never an auto-commit.

Levels

- **L1:** specialists inside each agent.
- **L2:** a cooler fails, then Directory rediscovery with reason cards.

- **L3:** donors and food banks negotiate with no central decider, compared against first-come-first-served.

Review red flags

A central decider, an auto-commit, an invented number, an approval not tied to a version, a crop name in a rule, private household data reaching an agent, silent waste, or promising produce that isn't committed yet.

Source of truth: docs/MVP_DESIGN.md, CONTEXT.md, docs/adr/. Proposed items (exact models, fair-share numbers, headline metrics) may still change.